

**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ T 7 5 4 3

♥ Q 2

♦ K J 6

♣ T 3 2

♠ A Q 8 6 2

♥ A 4

♦ 9 5

♣ A K 8 7



♠ J 9

♥ J T 9 8 6

♦ Q 8 7 4

♣ Q 6

♠ K

♥ K 7 5 3

♦ A T 3 2

♣ J 9 5 4

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              | 1 ♠   | Pass | 1NT   |
| Pass         | 2 ♣   | Pass | 2NT   |
| Pass         | 3NT   |      |       |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 3NT by South |       |      |       |

North opens 1 ♠. What should you bid? You have 11 points, enough to respond 2 ♣, (or 2 ♦), in standard bidding, but not when using 2/1. So you bid 1NT, showing 6-12 points. North rebids 2 ♣. Again, this doesn't promise more than 3 ♣ - it's just leaving room for us to describe our hand with our second bid. What do we bid now?

We know North doesn't have 4 ♥s, so we show our above-minimum hand by bidding 2NT. North has extra values and raises to 3NT. North is happy to play Notrump. He assumes we must have something useful in ♦s and bids 3NT. 3NT seems to be a good contract. There are 8 top tricks and possibilities for a ninth winner in either ♠s, ♦s, or, (the best chance), ♣s.

**Board 2**

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ J 7 3  
♥ 2  
♦ A Q 7 6 4  
♣ K 9 6 3

♠ K 9 5

♥ T 6

♦ K T 3 2

♣ J T 5 4



♠ A Q T 4

♥ K 9 8 4

♦ J 8

♣ Q 8 7

♠ 8 6 2

♥ A Q J 7 5 3

♦ 9 5

♣ A 2

South opens 1♥. What should we bid? We respond 1NT, just as in standard bidding. The difference is that in this case the 1NT response is forcing on South. South rebids ♥s, promising at least a 6-card suit.

You have nothing to say over 2♥ except pass. Notice that this is the same bidding and same final contract that would have been reached with standard bidding. Using 2/1 is often like that.

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
|             |       |      | 1♥    |
| Pass        | 1NT   | Pass | 2♥    |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 2♥ by South |       |      |       |

**Board 3**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 6 4 3

♥ K Q J 3 2

♦ J 3 2

♣ T 8

♠ K J 2

♥ 8 7 4

♦ A Q 9 7 5

♣ Q 2



♠ 8 7

♥ A 5

♦ 4

♣ K J 9 7 6 5 4 3

♠ A Q T 9 5

♥ T 9 6

♦ K T 8 6

♣ A

How do you open the bidding? You open 1♠. North responds 2♦, a natural 2/1 force to game. What do you rebid?

You cannot rebid your ♠s, but you have decent support for partner's ♦s, so raise to 3♦. You are in a game forcing auction so it won't end there. North always intended to play a ♠ contract. He now bids 4♠, using Fast Arrival to indicate he has no slam aspirations. 4♠ is cold, and if the defenders don't take their ♥ tricks immediately you will make an overtrick.

West

North

East

South

Pass

2♦

Pass

1♠

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by South

**Board 4**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 8 5  
 ♥ J T 6 5 3 2  
 ♦ Q J 9  
 ♣ A

♠ K 9 2  
 ♥ A K 8 7 4  
 ♦ K T 7  
 ♣ T 8



♠ A 7 4 3  
 ♥ Q  
 ♦ A 6 4 2  
 ♣ 7 6 4 3

♠ J T 6  
 ♥ 9  
 ♦ 8 5 3  
 ♣ K Q J 9 5 2

West

North

East

South

1 ♥

Dbl

2 ♣<sup>1</sup>

All Pass

1. 6+ ♣s, fewer than 10 points

2 ♣ by South

North opens 1 ♥ and East Doubles.

After the intervening Takeout Double **2/1 is OFF**. If you had 10 or more points you would Redouble. So even with only 9 points you can bid 2 ♣ without fear that North will think you have a strong hand. North also knows everything mentioned above so he passes.

**Board 5**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ T 5 3  
 ♥ T 6 5  
 ♦ A T 4  
 ♣ T 8 3 2

♠ Q J 2

♥ J 2

♦ Q J 8 6 2

♣ A K J



♠ -

♥ A 9 8 4 3

♦ 9 5

♣ Q 9 7 6 5 4

♠ A K 9 8 7 6 4

♥ K Q 7

♦ K 7 3

♣ -

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
|          |       |      | 1 ♠   |
| Pass     | 2 ♦   | Pass | 2 ♠   |
| Pass     | 3 ♠   | Pass | 4 ♣   |
| Pass     | 4 ♠   |      |       |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

4 ♠ by South

figured the odds favored that one Ace being a red one and tried the slam. Moral: Don't use Blackwood when you have a void.

You have a great hand - how will you start the bidding? You open 1 ♠. North responds 2 ♦, a 2/1 force to game. You have a big hand, perhaps in the slam range, but first priority is to set a trump suit. So you contend yourself with a rebid of 2 ♠. North agrees on trumps by bidding 3 ♠ (not Fast Arrival). What do you do now? Now you make your slam try by using a Control-showing cue-bid. She bids 4 ♣, showing first or second round control of the suit (Ace or king, or singleton or void). North bids 4 ♠. What do you do now?

North's next bid would be a control-showing bid of her own - IF SHE HAD ONE. Since she cannot win the first or second round of either red suit she just returns to 4 ♠. South realizes that they are off two red Aces and passes. Notice that South did not fall into the Blackwood trap. If you HAD asked for Aces, North would have shown one Ace and South wouldn't know what to do next. She might have